One way to do this would be to combine a secure encryption scheme like AES in CTR mode with HMAC. For example, you might make an `EncryptedTokenStore` that encrypts data using AES and then combine that with the existing `HmacTokenStore` for authentication. But there are two ways you could combine these two stores: first encrypting and then applying HMAC, or first applying HMAC and then encrypting the token and the tag together. It turns out that only the first of these is generally secure and is known as *Encrypt-then-MAC* (EtM). Because it is easy to get this wrong, cryptographers have developed several dedicated authenticated encryption modes such as *Galois/Counter Mode* (GCM) for AES. JOSE supports both GCM and EtM encryption modes, which you'll examine in section 6.3.3, but first we'll look at a simpler alternative.

6.3.2 Authenticated encryption with NaCl

Because cryptography is complex with many subtle details to get right, a recent trend has been for cryptography libraries to provide higher-level APIs that hide many of these details from developers. The most well-known of these is the *Networking and Cryptography Library* (NaCl, https://nacl.cr.yp.to) designed by Daniel Bernstein. NaCl (pronounced “salt”, as in sodium chloride) provides high level operations for authenticated encryption, digital signatures, and other cryptographic primitives but hides many of the details of the algorithms being used. Using a high-level library designed by experts such as NaCl is the safest option when implementing cryptographic protections